CLOSING ALL OR MULTIPLE INDEXES

We can close multiple indexes by using comma-separated indexes (including wildcards).

Listing 6.28 Closing multiple indexes

```
POST cars1,*mov*,students*/_close
```

Finally, if we want to halt all live operations on indexes in a cluster, we can issue a close index API call (`_close`) with either `_all` or `*`, as shown in the next listing (be sure the `action.destructive_requires_name` propertyliases is set to `false` to avoid a "wildcard expression not allowed" error).

Listing 6.29 Closing all indexes

```
POST */_close
```

Closes all indexes in the cluster

AVOIDING DESTABILIZING THE SYSTEM

As you can imagine, closing (or opening) *all* indexes may destabilize the system. It's one of those super admin capabilities that, if executed without forethought, can lead to disastrous results, including taking down the system or making it irreparable. Closing indexes blocks read/write operations and thus minimizes the overhead of maintaining cluster shards. The resources are purged, and memory is reclaimed on the closed indexes.

Can we disable the ability to close indexes? Yes, we can disable the close feature if we never want to close any indexes. By disabling this functionality, we allow indexes to be operational forever (unless we delete them). To do this, we set the `cluster.indices.close.enable` property to `false` (it is `true` by default) on the cluster using the configuration settings.

Listing 6.30 Disabling the closing indexes feature

```
PUT _cluster/settings
{
  "persistent": {
    "cluster.indices.close.enable":false
  }
}
```

6.5.2 Opening indexes

Opening an index kick-starts the shards back into business; once they're ready, they are open for indexing and searching. We can open a closed index by simply calling the `_open` API.

Listing 6.31 Putting the index back into operation

```
POST cars/_open
```